

FOUNDATIONS OF CYBERSECURITY

2026 – 2027 · COURSE SYLLABUS



YEARLONG · GRADES 9–12 · ROOM 2115 · TRACK: COMPTIA SECURITY+

INSTRUCTOR

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HOW TO READ THIS

Every section below is tagged with who sets the rule: the State of Texas, Leander ISD, Vista Ridge, or this classroom.

WELCOME

SET BY
MR. MORALES

Welcome to The Ridge. This year we study how computers and networks get attacked, and how they get defended. You will build the same skills the people who do this for a living use every day.

Everything about how this class runs is in this syllabus. Keep it somewhere you can find it. If you or your family need anything, reach out. Go Rangers.

MR. MORALES'S PRO TIP

Finish your work during class. Then you walk out with nothing hanging over you: no homework, full credit on the assignment, and you come back ready for the next topic.

COURSE OVERVIEW

SET BY
TEXAS TEKS

Foundations of Cybersecurity is a yearlong course that introduces the concepts, tools, and careers of the field. Instruction centers on implementing and monitoring security across networks and computer systems.

You will investigate how to identify and defend against real threats like hackers, eavesdropping, and network attacks. Every unit connects to current events plus the cyber ethics and laws that govern them.

This course begins your preparation for the **CompTIA Security+** exam, the focus of the next course in the sequence, Cybersecurity Capstone.

ALIGNED TO [**Foundations of Cybersecurity, TEKS 127.792**](#)

WHAT TO BRING

SET BY
THIS CLASSROOM

- › A computer. Use the computers provided in class. Bring a school laptop only when it is absolutely necessary.
- › portal.cyber.org account. Provided in class.
- › A way to take notes. Bring something to write with and something to write on.

Need help getting supplies? Contact me. No student goes without.

STUDENT EXPECTATIONS

SET BY
THIS CLASSROOM

These are simple, and every one of them transfers to whatever workplace you end up in.

- › **Be on time.** Be in your seat and ready when the bell rings. School policy applies to late arrivals.
- › **Be prepared.** Bring your materials every day and have completed work ready at the start of class. Submit Google Classroom assignments on time.
- › **Participate.** Listen during lectures, join the activities, ask real questions.
- › **Manage your time.** Complete and submit every assignment by its due date.
- › **Own your learning, earn your grade.** Try your best, learn from your mistakes, and ask for help when you need it.
- › **Respect others.** Treat classmates, teachers, staff, and substitutes with kindness. Listen when someone else is speaking. Bullying and harassment are not tolerated.
- › **Watch your language.** Swearing, insults, and derogatory comments have no place here.
- › **Respect property.** Take care of the furniture, equipment, and materials. Do not deface or damage anything, and clean up after yourself and your classmates.

PHONES & DEVICES

SET BY
STATE OF TEXAS

Under **House Bill 1481**, phones and other personal electronic devices, including smart watches, tablets, gaming devices, and headphones or earbuds with cellular connectivity, may not be used on campus between 8:05 AM and 3:35 PM. That includes restrooms, hallways, and lunch. Make electronic MINGA hall passes on a computer.

Devices stay **away and unseen** in your backpack or bag. Not on your person, not in a pocket, not in a waistband. If you do not carry a bag, leave your device in the AP office.

- FIRST INCIDENT** Warning and contact home
- SECOND INCIDENT** Referral to your AP

Repeated violations can mean a parent or guardian picks the device up from VRHS, and you may lose the privilege of bringing one to school. Continued violations follow the Vista Ridge and Leander ISD Student Code of Conduct. Remember that this is state law.

HOW GRADES WORK

SET BY
LEANDER ISD

Grades are split three ways.

- DAILY WORK & LABS** **25%**
- QUIZZES** **25%**
- EXAMS & PROJECTS** **50%**

LATE WORK & REDOS

SET BY
THIS CLASSROOM

Work is due during your scheduled class period. Anything turned in after that is late and can earn a **maximum score of 80**.

Late work can still be redone. You may need to finish steps I assign first, such as attending tutorials or making corrections. A redo replaces your score with up to an 80, and if you already scored above an 80 that grade stands. You have a one-week window.

Turn in all work and final redos at least one week before grades are due at the end of the grading period.

MISSED WORK & ABSENCES

SET BY
LEANDER ISD

If you are absent for any reason, check in with me the day you return so we can set your make-up assignments, their due dates, and the dates you will take any missed quizzes or exams. You get one day of make-up time for every day you were out, so two days absent means two days to make up. On the A/B schedule, one day means one class period. Two exceptions: work already assigned and due on the day you were absent is due the day you return, and a quiz or exam already scheduled for that day is given the day you return.

CONTINUOUS IMPROVEMENT

SET BY
LEANDER ISD

If you score below a 70 on a learning target, Continuous Improvement is available to you. We build a plan together, you relearn the skill, and you show mastery.

Most of this happens during class. If class time runs short, use tutorials. Per district policy, Continuous Improvement is available to every student who fails a six weeks.

ACADEMIC HONESTY

SET BY
VISTA RIDGE HS

Academic dishonesty is not tolerated. If you cheat or help someone else cheat, including sharing completed work through Google Drive, the offense is documented, your parent or guardian is contacted, and a referral goes to the AP office for your record.

- › **First offense on daily work.** Automatic zero.
- › **First offense on an exam or project.** Redo the work for a maximum score of 50, or accept the zero.
- › **Habitual offenses.** Zero regardless of assignment weight, and loss of all exemption privileges.

Plagiarism is copying from any source, including AI, websites, books, and classmates, or presenting ideas that did not originate with you. Sources are a good thing when you credit them properly.

TUTORIALS & HELP

SET BY
THIS CLASSROOM

TUESDAY THROUGH THURSDAY · A DAYS AND B DAYS

BEFORE SCHOOL 7:30 – 8:00 AM · Room 2115

AFTER SCHOOL 3:35 – 4:05 PM · Room 2115

RANGER TIME

I will have open tutorial times on movement days for Ranger Time.

LISD CTE NON-DISCRIMINATION STATEMENT

Leander ISD does not discriminate on the basis of race, color, national origin, sex, or disability in its programs or activities and provides equal access to the Boy Scouts and other designated youth groups. The following person has been designated to handle inquiries regarding the nondiscrimination policies: Bryan Miller, Title IX Coordinator; 204 W. South Street Leander, TX 78646; Bryan.Miller@Leanderisd.org; (512) 570-0000.

Leander ISD no discrimina por motivos de raza, color, origen nacional, sexo o discapacidad en sus programas o actividades y proporciona igualdad de acceso a los Boy Scouts y otros grupos juveniles designados. La siguiente persona ha sido designada para atender las consultas relacionadas con las políticas de no discriminación: Bryan Miller, Coordinador del Título IX; 204 W. South Street Leander, TX 78646; Bryan.Miller@Leanderisd.org; (512) 570-0000.

Leander ISD తన కార్యక్రమాలు లేదా కార్యకలాపాలలో జాతి, వర్ణం, జాతీయ జన్మ మూలం, లింగం లేదా వైకల్యం ఆధారంగా వివక్షను చూపించదు మరియు బాలుర స్కౌట్లు మరియు ఇతర హోదా కల నియమిత యువజన సమూహాలకు సమాన ప్రాప్యతను అందిస్తుంది. వివక్షారహిత పాలసీలకు సంబంధించిన విచారణలను చేపట్టడం కోసం ఈ క్రింది వ్యక్తి నియమితులయ్యారు: Bryan Miller, టైటిల్ IX కోఆర్డినేటర్; 204 W. South Street Leander, TX 78646; Bryan.Miller@Leanderisd.org; (512) 570-0000.

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